



COUNTY OF SONOMA

575 ADMINISTRATION
DRIVE, ROOM 102A
SANTA ROSA, CA 95403

SUMMARY REPORT

Agenda Date: 8/20/2019

To: Board of Supervisors

Department or Agency Name(s): County Administrator and Emergency Management Department

Staff Name and Phone Number: Sheryl Bratton, 565-2241 Christopher Godley, 565-2052

Vote Requirement: 4/5th

Supervisory District(s): All

Title:

Continue Proclamation of Local Emergency Due to the Sonoma Complex Fires

Recommended Actions:

Adopt a Resolution Continuing the Proclamation of Local Emergency Issued on October 9, 2017, for another 60 Days Due to Damage Arising from the Sonoma Complex Fires.

Executive Summary:

This item requests the Board of Supervisors adopt a resolution approving a 60-day continuation of the October 9, 2017, Proclamation of a Local Emergency in the Sonoma County Operational Area due to the effects of the Sonoma Complex Fires. The Complex Fires began on Sunday, October 8, 2017, causing extreme property damage and health and safety concerns. The County Administrator proclaimed the Existence of a Local Emergency on October 9, 2017, and the Board of Supervisors adopted Resolution No. 17-0389 ratifying that proclamation on October 10, 2017. As required by Government Code section 8630, the Board must review the proclamation of local emergency every 60 days and determine if there is a need for continuing the local emergency.

Discussion:

The Complex Fires began on Sunday, October 8, 2017. In response, the Emergency Operations Center (EOC) was activated at approximately 12:00 a.m. on Monday, October 9, 2017, to assist with managing the impacts. In the early morning hours on Monday, the County issued advisory evacuation notices to various impacted areas of Sonoma County. Shelter was made available at various locations throughout the County, and first responders were actively engaged in multiple areas throughout the County as the complex fires advanced.

The County Administrator/Director of Emergency Services issued a Proclamation of Existence of Local Emergency in Sonoma County Operational Area in the early morning hours of Monday, October 9, 2017, as soon as reports of quickly moving fires and health and safety concerns arrived. Later that day, the County Administrator supplemented that Proclamation and requested state and federal assistance. The Board of Supervisors ratified the County Administrator's Proclamation of the Existence of a Local Emergency on October 10, 2017. California Government Code section 8630 of Article 14, Local Emergency, of Chapter 7 of the Emergency Services Act requires that the County review the need for continuing the local emergency at least

once every 60 days until the governing body terminates the local emergency.

The scope of disaster caused by the fast-moving fire and widespread scale of the destruction instigated the Governor of the State of California to proclaim a State of Emergency (declaring eligibility for State assistance) and brought about the President of the United States to issue a Declaration of a Major Disaster for the State of California, making the Complex Fires eligible for Federal assistance. At the time, the Sonoma Complex Fires resulted in the most devastating wildfires in the history of the State of California. In Sonoma County alone, the fires caused the death of at least 24 people, charred 110,720 acres, destroyed 6,950 structures (including 5,143 housing structures), and displaced more than 100,000 Sonoma County residents.

The Sonoma Complex Fires left a large debris field in their wake, which creates unique removal concerns due to the potential presence of hazardous materials and the large scale of the incident and poses a threat to public health and safety. Debris cleanup has proceeded via both public and private cleanup programs. The total number of properties included within the debris removal program was 4,888, including 3,674 properties that participated in the public-cleanup program, and 1,214 properties that participated in the private program.

The public debris clean-up program is complete. In the public program, 722 properties were evaluated by the California Office of Emergency Services for over-excavation and 381 determined eligible and have been backfilled. Two properties in the private program remain incomplete.

As long as any fire debris remains to be cleared, it poses an imminent and extensive threat to public health and safety, the environment (including creating serious concerns for water quality and supply due to the presence of hazardous materials and the damage to sewer service laterals), public infrastructure, and undamaged property.

In addition, the wildfires ravaged hillsides leaving large swaths with inadequate vegetation, creating threats of erosion and landslides.

The cleanup efforts in Sonoma County were aided by a relatively light rainy season in 2017-18. However, major winter storms have buffeted the region in 2019, including in the burn zone. Slope failures have impacted infrastructure and threatened waterways demonstrating the need for continued erosion control efforts to address secondary hazards post-fire.

Staff recommend that the Board adopt the attached Resolution finding that the severity and pervasiveness of the Sonoma Complex Fires disaster poses an ongoing and imminent threat to public safety and undamaged property that warrants the need to continue the local emergency as authorized by Government Code section 8630.

Prior Board Actions:

Resolutions Declaring the Need for Continuing the Local Emergency Pursuant to Government Code 8360 due to the Sonoma Complex Fires:

May 21, 2019, Resolution No. 19-0227

April 2, 2019, Resolution No. 19-0134

January 8, 2019, Resolution No. 19-0007

December 11, 2018, Resolution No. 18-0514

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November 13, 2018, Resolution No. 18-0490

October 23, 2018, Resolution No. 18-0450

September 25, 2018, Resolution No. 18-0395

August 28, 2018, Resolution No. 18-0337

August 7, 2018, Resolution No. 18-0301

July 10, 2018, Resolution No. 18-0266

June 11, 2018, Resolution No. 18-0248

June 5, 2018, Resolution No. 18-0224

May 8, 2018, Resolution No. 18-0161

April 17, 2018, Resolution No. 18-0131

March 20, 2018, Resolution No. 18-0095

February 20, 2018, Resolution No. 18-0068

February 13, 2018, Resolution NO. 18-0056

January 23, 2018, Resolution No. 18-0022

December 29, 2017, Resolution No. 17-0515

December 5, 2017, Resolution No. 17-0457

November 7, 2017, Resolution No. 17-0431

October 10, 2017, Resolution No. 17-0389 ratifying the County Administrator's proclamation of the existence of a local emergency with the Sonoma County Operation Area.

FISCAL SUMMARY

Expenditures	FY 19-20 Adopted	FY20-21 Projected	FY 21-22 Projected
Budgeted Expenses			
Additional Appropriation Requested			
Total Expenditures			
Funding Sources			
General Fund/WA GF			
State/Federal			
Fees/Other			
Use of Fund Balance			
Contingencies			
Total Sources			

Narrative Explanation of Fiscal Impacts:

Staffing Impacts:			
Position Title (Payroll Classification)	Monthly Salary Range (A - I Step)	Additions (number)	Deletions (number)

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Narrative Explanation of Staffing Impacts (If Required):

Attachments:

Emergency Resolution

Related Items “On File” with the Clerk of the Board: